



Bringing back the old, conven-tional and familiar menu

the installation for `htop` after one more confirmation. Simple eh?

The Gnome menu

If for some reason you find the above mentioned menu slightly unfamiliar to use and want your old conventional Gnome menu back, then all you need to do is right-click on the bottom panel. In the add to panel window, select the Main Menu that will give you back your Gnome menu, and obviously since you are in a free world, you can retain both if you choose.

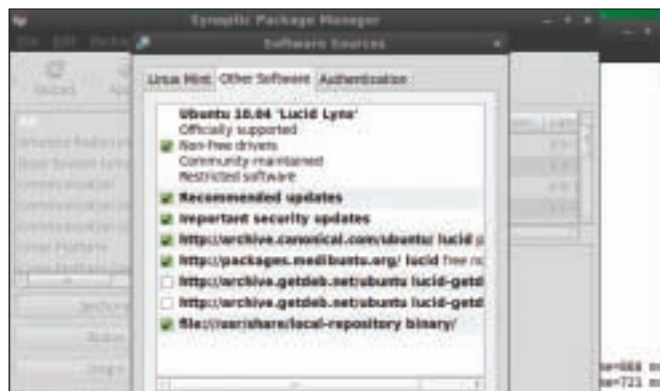
Ubuntu packages

A common confusion novices have is between the utility and functionality of the Software Manager. In Ubuntu's case it is called Ubuntu Software Center

and Synaptic Package Manager. Think of Software Manager as a proper subset of Synaptic Package Manager. While the former lists only complete applications (more often then not with a GUI), the latter lists them along side with all individual libraries and documentation files. So say you will find 'VLC' or 'Totem Media Player' in the software manager, but in the Package manager alongside finding them you will also have the option of installing underlying libraries for them individually as well like `gststreamer-bad` or `libXYZ-dev`.

get-deb repositories

Get-Deb is an independent project that aims to bringing easy installation of many great applications that are not by default found in the Ubuntu/



Enabling the GetDeb repositories in Linux Mint

Mint repositories. Sometimes it includes a new version than the one available in the in repositories.

Mint allows one click addition of the GetDeb Repositories (supported since GetDeb v2) so that you can download all the packages either from the Ubuntu default repositories or the GetDeb archive in the one single, unified and familiar interface of Synaptic Package Manager.

To do this, open Package Manager found under the systems tab in the start menu. Go to Settings > Repositories and then check GetDeb repositories. Click Close to continue and when asked, select reload package information. The above process can also be accomplished manually by uncommenting (removing the '#' symbol) in the `/etc/apt/sources.list` file.

Desktop Cube

Assuming you have the correct drivers, go to All applications > Preferences > Appearance from the Mint Menu. In the Visual Effects tab, select Custom. Once the Desktop effects are enabled, you can click on Preferences to enable the Desktop Cube and tweak many more features. Open Synaptic Package Manager and install `CompizConfig-Settings-Manager`.

AptonCD

If you have ever wondered about losing all your favourite packages in a reinstall after you downloaded them so laboriously, then Mint brings you a solution for this. Go to Menu > All Applications > Administration AptonCD.

Now from the AptonCD application, select Create to open a menu from where you can select your desired packages (or all of them) to backup and store them as an ISO file. You can later restore them easily using AptonCD to the default cache location. Remember this won't install all of them, but only restore them on your hard disk, you can install them from the package-manager, but this time the package-manager won't download from the internet, but use the package on your hard disk if a new version isn't there.

Ndiswrapper

Linux in the last 5 years has come a long long way in supporting hardware out-of-the-box, with more than 90 per cent of all hardware never requiring another click from the user to work. Even then, wireless remains a weak-spot in hardware support. To counter this, the 'Ndiswrapper' project has done an excellent job of making your wireless driver written for Windows work flawlessly with Linux, and Mint includes



Easily back up and restore your downloaded packages